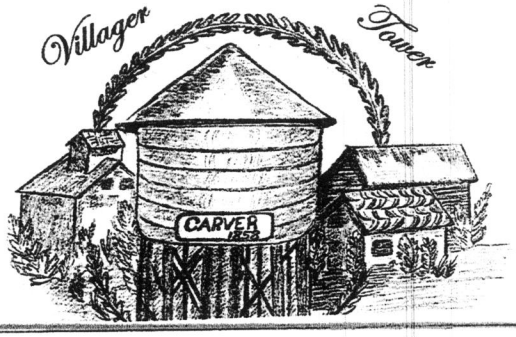
Volume XXXV
Number # Two Hundred Thirty One
December 2006 - January 2007



Gregg's Place

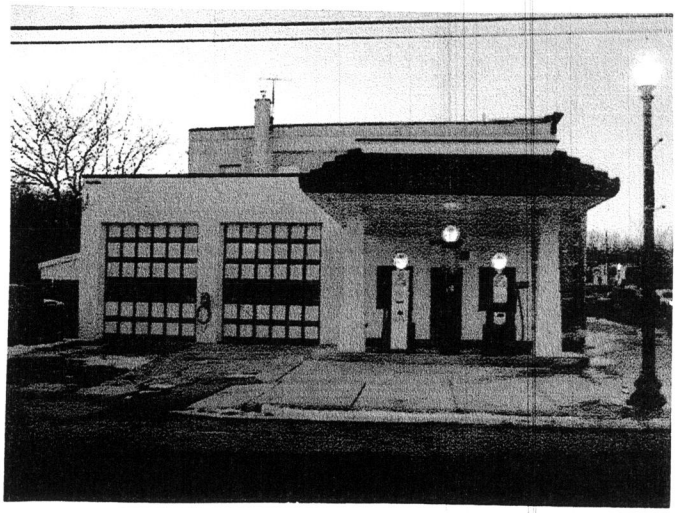
Do we begin our footsteps in the present and go backwards? Or do we step back into the past time and walk our way into the future? Research is putting together a jig saw puzzle. A panorama of revelations unfolds as each puzzle piece falls into place. The pieces that are missing or lost leave void in the perfect landscaping of the fabulous display created.

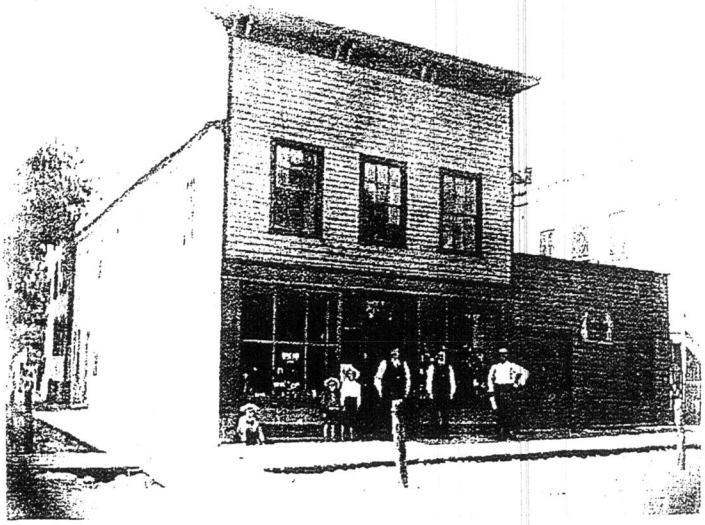
At this point, the author chose to step back in time and continue seeking those missing pieces to this picture. And the trouble with this choice is the length of this particular feature article. Like the restoration that had been done on Gregg's Garage at the corner of Broadway and Main in Carver (alias County Road #40), and formerly known as the infamous "Mobile Station" with the Flying Red Horse symbol, had to be done in sections. So in this portion of the account, the station is yet to be built. So, as we march forward with the information found thus far, the issues of the *Villager Tower* will split this feature into sections until we have achieved a full panoramic view of days gone by.

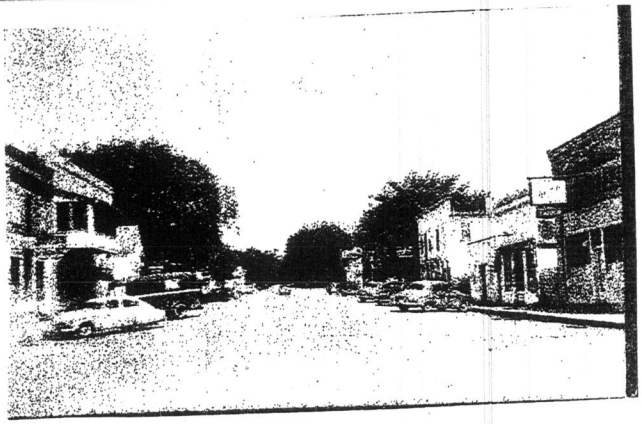
Before the Mobile Station: from the county abstracts for this Carver block we are dealing with three, plus, city lots. There are also multiple land transfers made for various reasons. In the early days of the Carver settlement a lot of activity took place. We start at the point of June 1857 for the Bond of Deed from Samuel Fullerton to Henry Gehl to erect a store, described in the abstract as 20' x 40', two stories high. This is followed by Quit Claim deeds in 1861 stating that Alex Ramsey relinquishes property claims to Samuel Fullerton, and Fullerton in turn relinquishes claim to John Hein, with reference to the Carver Land Company. The Bond for Deed then transfers ownership to William Glitschka in 1863.

An affidavit given by A G Holm states that the first occupancy of Lot #12 was William Glitschka, who owned the building in 1877 and part of 1878, operating a grocery store and liquor store. He was succeeded by Peter Thorsen who also operated a grocery/liquor store, but not owning the property. It is further stated that in 1879 reputed partners, H H Holm and Ole Johnson conducted business as Holm & Johnson. Running a grocery and general store. H H Holm married Josephine Dauwalter and the partnership was dissolved between the men. Then Holm alone conducted the grocery business, retiring about 1904. (see photo – with warehouse on side of store) This building will be replaced by the filling station as we now see. After much thought and examination of maps, it was finally deciphered that the lower structure on the right (to the north) of the grocery store is then labeled as a warehouse.

In the next section of this feature to the existence of the station will walk us through the 1900's events proving to be quite a busy block, probably just like the other areas of town in the fast settling busy river city. If you have any information to add, please contact Ricki and leave a message at 952) 448-5126.







Certified Local Government

The Heritage Preservation Commission discussed and submitted a recommendation to the city council to that the Certified Local Government grant be applied for to update the existing Historical District design guide-lines and that this submission needs to be processed immediately to the MN State Preservation Office because the preliminary deadline is in January. Comment was also made that the Historical District needs to have more uniformity in its design guidelines.

The commission also inserted their input into the rewriting of the Historical District residential, commercial and city lot ordinances. Statement was made that the existing city lot ordinances are out of date with the actual historical reality and the ordinances need to be revised with separate ordinances specific to the historic district. Revision would facilitate creating a more historical appearance. Redrafting of a new zoning ordinance could involve a year or more to complete. The city was petitioned to start this process on the historical district ordinances immediately.

The commission also discussed the agreement with developer in the Spring Creek development concerning the interpretive sign and text. Specifications included construction of two monuments erected along the trail which would be one sided with the bases to incorporate brick from the demolished Grimm farm house. The city was asked for their input on the verbiage of one of the monuments. The Grimm family would document the history of their farm on the other monument.

The commission discussed voting on the best restored historical property in Carver. They reviewed two nominated properties. Decision was made to award the Heritage Preservation Commission Plaque to the restoration of Mobil Station and office at 200 and 204 Broadway Street.

Historical Interpretive Signs

The council discussed approval of the content on the historical interpretive signs adjacent to the Spring Creek Trail. The city planner reminded them of the condition of approval. One monument would have information chosen by the Grimm family and the second monument would contain information chosen by the city. A Heritage Preservation Commissioner completed a preliminary draft of language which would be put onto another monument. The commission also had submitted their choice of recommendation. Motion was made and carried utilizing the recommended choice of content for one of the interpretive signs. Motion was made and carried that Option #2 contents be forwarded onto the Park and Recreation Commission to be set onto a monument at the southern part of the trail.

The ideas I stand for are not min. I borrowed them from Socrates. I swiped them from Chesterfield. I stole them from Jesus. And I put them in a book. If you don't like their rules, whose would you use?

– Dale Carnegie

Ordinance Amendments

The council was informed of the Heritage Preservation Commission's request for ordinance amendments for the downtown historical district. The city planner reported that the city's historic district currently has a classified mix of residential and Central Business District zoning districts. Many properties do not meet the minimum standards prescribed by the residential zoning district and have legal nonconforming status. It was the commission's opinion that due to the distinctly different nature of housing and lots between the core city and the newer developments that it would only be appropriate to consider development of a new zoning classification applying to the downtown historical standards in terms of zoning requirements.

The Central Business District is the only commercial district currently available within the city's Zoning Ordinance. The city will be adding additional districts applying to the future development areas of the city, with a major 2007 update planned. This issue had been planned for, however the Heritage Preservation Commission has requested separation of a portion of the ordinance to be separate from the larger project as it impacts restoration efforts in the historic district. Motion was made and carried with all ayes directing the city planner to begin ordinance changes applying to the historic district.

Municipal Utilities

The council discussed the proposed septic tank removal program with the Public Utilities Director. There could be a problem I the future with removal at the present rate with the current Metropolitan Council schedule. The present plans could conflict causing a limit set on building permits being issued. The director proposed a program for the council to review. Preparation also was required in the tank removal process. Access to many systems resulted in problems. The council discussed the issue. The mayor was of the opinion that a policy should be established to deal with the issues.

The city engineer discussed and reviewed the Metropolitan Council Environmental Services Interceptor Route Concept and Preliminary Schedule. The council reviewed a slide presentation updating the council on the progress. Costs of the system were discussed. This system is designed to expand and meet the needs of the city for the area covered in the Comprehensive Plan. A joint cooperative agreement between the city and the Metropolitan Council is also being worked on.

Concept Plan

The council reviewed the concept plan submitted for development of the Forner property. Statement was made reflective of the assessments from the Mt Hope project and the pending assessments from the Forner Lane project. The city planner's comments were also reviewed.

Design Build Project

The council reviewed with the city engineer the "Design Build Project – Trunk Highway #212 and County Road #147 Interchange" portion of the project. The MN Dot staff negotiated a savings on the casing extension for future Municipal Utilities in the area of Highway #212, west of County Road #11.

Heritage Preservation Award

There's been a lot of talk as of late about the busy corner in Carver. What corner you ask? The building on the intersection of Broadway and Main on the south side of town. Greg and Meg Witt won the very first Heritage Preservation Award presented in the City of Carver. This is an event that the Heritage Preservation Commission and the City of Carver decided to begin as a new tradition in the city.

The award involved the year's best restoration or improvement in the Carver Historical District. The commission examined two properties being renovated, but the Broadway location took the award. The award was presented at the "Taste of Christmas" celebration in the Church-By-The-River. In addition to the plaque. The Witt's will also be entitled to display a larger traveling recognition sign on the properties during all of 2007.

Nominations were received and reviewed during October and November whereupon the members of the Heritage Preservation Commission voted and selected their choice. The properties at addresses 200 and 204 Broadway were badly deteriorated prior to restoration. Using historical photos, the storefront, which had been walled up, was recreated. The vintage gas station had been owned by MN Valley Oil Company. Presently, there are three vintage gasoline pumps being displayed. The restored facility is the perfect backdrop for memorable photography for vintage enthusiasts who will park and recapture the past even if only for a fleeting temporary moment.

River Bluff Estates

The engineer told the council that the developer requested date extension on the completion of the plat named River Bluff Estates. Items to be finished yet are the landscaping of trees, utility work order items, and pond safety/ aquatic bench. The council discussed the conditions of the pond. The council was told that there have been many discussions on fixing the pond problem. The attorney submitted the suggestion that costs be determined concerning proposed solutions. The attorney also stated that building permits should not be issued until the issue is resolved either. The engineer will work with the developer to reach a solution as soon as possible. The developer was also told that this project has been very frustrating for the council.

"Time hs no division to mark its passage, there is never a thuder-storm or blare of trumpets to announce the beginning of a new month or year. Even when a new century begins it is only we mortals who ring bells and fire off pistols."

- Thomas Mann

Micellaneous

The city engineer informed the council that city had received a grant for the Storm Sewer Improvements concerning the Clean Water Legacy Grant. This money would be utilized to improve the area when the Metropolitan Council Environmental Services project is done.

The engineer reviewed with the council the results of their examination of a portion of the historic 4th Street Bridge. The Public Works Director has drafted a short term/low cost solution to prevent further damage. The director had already completed two of the three recommendations. The council stated their desire to review the overall bridge condition at a work session.

The council was told that the amount of money being offered for liquidated damages to the city was less than claimed concerning the Water Treatment Plant issue. Recommendation was made to execute a Take Over Agreement that would provide for CNA to hire Bor-Son to get the project completed and reserves the right to fight over liquidated damages. The city could let the bank initiate court action requesting the court's decision on retainage distribution. The city would then submit their claim with the county district court for the liquidated damages. The council discussed their options. Motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay to accept the amount offered plus engineering fees.

The council was told that the Park and Recreation Commission discussed the feasibility of a Community Center in Carver. Further discussion will be held among the Park and Recreation Commissioners.

The new Carver County Commissioner, Randy Maluchnik introduced himself to the City of Carver Council members. Mr Maluchnik will be the commissioner representing the City of Carver.

Senior's Commission / Task Force

The council was told that many of the Carver County cities have Senior's Commissions and that the Carver Council should at least contemplate the notion. This issue had been discussed previously. Task Force was the alternative. It was considered that the senior citizen residents should be represented. Suggestion was submitted to include an invitation and or article in the newsletter for input from seniors.

The council reviewed the presentation from Ms Maureen Melgaard-Schneider from the Lifetime Senior Commission. This commission works for provision of services to senior citizens relating to transportation, affordable housing and other issues so that residents can remain in their community where they have resided for long periods. The council was reminded that senior citizens are a vital parts of a community as consumers, volunteers and sometimes part of the work force. Once the commission is in place the council would be responsible for dealing with senior issues, submit recommendations benefiting the seniors, as well as initiate programs and services.

Great Energy Transmission Line

MN Valley Electric Cooperative (MVEC) is the electric service provider in and around Victoria and surrounding communities in the area. Victoria has experienced unprecedented growth in both residential and commercial sectors of the community. MVEC plans to build a new Victoria Substation to meet increasing electrical needs. Great River Energy is a generation and transmission cooperative who supplies wholesale power to distribution cooperatives in Minnesota and Wisconsin. Great River Energy proposes to construct this transmission line to service the new substation.

Representatives from the Great River Energy Transmission Line-Victoria project approached the Dahlgren Township Board proposing a substation and transmission line in Victoria. The line was proposed to go through the township. An interconnection point would be somewhere between County Road #140 and Creek Ridge Lane and along Guernsey Avenue to County Road #11. Additional information is available from the board.

East Union School

The Dahlgren Golf Club is not available to the township board for the March election and Annual Meeting. The East Union School has made themselves available to the township. The township regular meeting will be held on March 12th. The Township Election will be held on March 13th from 10 AM to 8 PM followed by the Annual Meeting about 8:15 PM.

Hidden Bluffs

The engineer informed the council that the Hidden Bluffs development had been reviewed for updates and acceptance. The council directed the developer to provide a two year warranty bond versus a one year warranty bond and to adjust the entrance monuments per the landscape plans. The developer complied with the warranty bond and the monuments received the pyramidal tops. Motion was made and carried authorizing acceptance of the improvements and Letter of Credit Reduction upon payment of the balance of invoices due.

City Hall Task Force

The council was told that the committee of the City Hall Task Force had met and discussed and voted on a location for a proposed City Hall. The vote had favored the present Waste Water Treatment Plant site. This site was favored due to the fact that the city is presently working with the Metropolitan Council for the wastewater treatment services. If the city connects to the MUSA line then the present treatment site would be abandoned. Whereupon, the site would be revamped to accommodate construction of a new city hall facility. The engineering firm had drawn up preliminary plans, describing highlights of the building and the expandability possibilities. The draft also visualized the parking area and the placement of the building. The design would be feasible for at least twenty years.

Fire Truck Repair

The council was informed of the necessity to repair one of the Fire Department trucks. The pump on the truck failed a pump test and requires rebuilding since it is inoperable. The gentlemen working on the maintenance of the truck in the past were conferred with and it was their opinion that the necessary repairs to have the pump certified required other service personnel. A two year warranty on a rebuilt pump would accompany the repairs made. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving the rebuilding of the machine impeller on Unit #108.

Carver Fire and Rescue

The council was told that the Carver Fire and Rescue would be sponsoring a "Pre Super Bowl" Breakfast and Silent Auction on Sunday, February 4th at 7AM at the Village Hall. Serving ends at 12:30 PM. Auction proceeds will be donated to Chief Dauwalter (Jerry) to help with his medical expenses. BE THERE! You can eat for $6 per person. How many of you know that Jerry served on the Fire Department for over thirty two years?

Carver Lions

The Carver Lions had a busy December according to Linda Schutz. Every month is a full schedule for the Carver Lions. This December because they were out making sure that the holidays were glistening brightly with their light display in the downtown park. Then there are the Christmas events, along with their Senior Luncheon. Can't forget about the Lion's Christmas party. Linda assures everyone that they all had lots of fun. Then once the holidays were behind them, they were off to Mankato to co-host mid-winter convention for their district.

Remember, you too can be a part of all of this fun. They meet at the Village Hall on the first and third Wednesday of the month at 6:30 PM. It's the only place to be.

East Union School

The East Union School Principal announced that they are excited to be moving forward with their partnership with the MN Valley National Wildlife Refuge with a school goal of 100% participation in a service learning project. Recently the school was awarded as recipients of two grants. One from the MN Valley Electric Company and the Jeffers Foundation Grant. The Jeffers Foundation purpose is to provide for direct primary education and development of primary education principles, model, and curricula aimed at teaching the young the value of wise stewardship of natural resources, the resources available to sustain and nourish it, and the means and methods which will ensure conservation and preservation of natural resources for the use and enjoyment of the present and future generations. It is the school's opinion that they are very fortunate to have the monetary support to move their project forward.

"The only thing that can save the world is the reclaiming of the awareness of the world. That's what poetry does"

Fire Department

The Fire Department officers for the 2007 year were decided. They are as follows:

Fire Chief:	Scott King
1st Assistant Chief:	Phil Clay
2nd Assistant Chief:	Dan Meyer
First Captain:	Dave Diethelm
Second Captain:	Scott Haas
Fire Marshall:	
Membert-at-Large:	Keith Goetze
Safety Officer:	Mike Ruegemer
Treasurer:	Mel Nelson
Secretary:	Paul Young

Congratulations!!!

Disclaimer

The 'unapproved' minutes of the council and the township have been referenced for the purposes of reporting news in the *"Villager Tower"* and creating the contents of this news-letter for the purpose of informing residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar — February 2007

February 2nd - GroundHog Day
Drill Night
February 3rd - Happy 65th Birthday Darrel!
February 5th - Council Meeting
February 6th - Carver's Women's Business Group Meeting
February 9th - Happy Birthday Brenna!
February 10th - Strategic Planning Session
February 12th - Lincoln's Birthday
Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Dahlgren Township Board Meeting
February 14th - Valentine's Day
SteamBoat Days Committee Meeting
February 15th - Happy Birthday Kim!
Happy Birthday Katie!
Happy Anniversary Dwight and Janet!
February 16th - Happy Birthday Tom!
February 18th - Happy Birthday Merva!
February 19th - President's Day
Drill Night
February 20th - Council Meeting
February 21st - Ash Wednesday
Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
SteamBoat Days Committee Meeting
February 22nd - Washington's Birthday
Fire Department Meeting Night
Happy Birthday Sandra!
February 26th - Comprehensive Plan Work Group Meeting
Blood Drive – Chaska VFW
February 27th - Happy Birthday Dad!
Planning Commission Meeting
February 28th - Open Registration for Carver Youth Baseball/Softball Association

Blood Drive

A Belated Thanks are extended to all those who helped with the Blood Drive recently in Carver. Are you aware that with one pint of blood, three lives could be saved. There will be another Blood Drive at the Chaska VFW on February 26th. If interested, contact Joan Rein for details. The Blood Drive is tentatively scheduled for Carver in April.

2007 Clean Up Day

The administrator reviewed the past years clean up day and the adequacy of the program. Various alternatives were discussed. The staff was asked to devise a plan for some type of clean up program for 2007.

Carver Youth Baseball / Softball Association

Happy New Years everyone.

It is the philosophy of this program that each player should learn through active participation; and that winning is the end result of a total team contribution. The purpose of this program is to provide children an opportunity to have fun, develop physically and socially, and to learn the basic fundamentals of the sport of baseball/softball.

Our programs offered will be T-Ball, Coach Pitch Baseball, Baseball and Softball.

One of the most exciting steps we have taken this year's to offer "Online Registration". This will streamline the registration process for you, help reduce the errors we have by missing information, hard to read and you can register anytime day or night. You will receive a confirmation back with the information you provided and the fee amount you will need to send in. This is a work in progress and we are excited to offer this for our 2007 registrations.
Steps to follow to access this thru the web are:
1. key in carver.govoffice.com
2. Select Sports and Fitness
3. Select 2007 CCYBSA Online Registration for 2007

When you submit the form we will get a notification that you have submitted a registration.

If anyone knows of a youth that *who has not signed up because of financial reasons, please contact Jane at 952-492-2907 or Cindy at 952-448-4760. Arrangements will be made.

Our Annual meeting will be held: January 31st at 6:30 PM in the Lower Level of the Village Hall

Open Registration will be held in the lower level of the Village Hall on February 28th at 6:30 PM to 8:30 PM.

Jane Thon
CCYBSA President

Tentative Agenda

City of Carver Council
Monday Evening 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Pledge of Allegiance
3) Approve Agenda
4) Petitions and Requests
5) Consent Agenda
6) Municipal Utilities Report
7) Building Inspector Report
8) City Planner Report
9) City Engineer Report
10) City Attorney Report
11) Administrator Report
12) Liaison Reports
13) Other Business
14) Adjourn

Carver Depot / Casey's

The council discussed the issue of whether or not the city was interested in issuing an approval for a beer license since it is the city's responsibility to issue it. The council discussed the item and the decision was made to issue the license. Question was asked whether or not Casey's would present any sign proposals to the Heritage Preservation Commission. The location is not within the Historic District, however request would be submitted for any changes proposed on the existing sign. The administrator stated that there was also interior remodeling discussed. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving a beer license for Casey's Retail Company doing business as (dba) Casey's General Store.

"People are like stained-glass windows. They sparkle and shine when the sun is out, but when the darkness sets in, their true beauty is revealed only if there is light from within."
- Elisabeth Kubler-Ross

Feasibility Study

The council reviewed acceptance of the Interceptor Feasibility Study and authorization of the Negotiation of the agreement. The engineering firm representatives and Metropolitan Council Environmental Services representatives were all in attendance of the meeting to present four alternatives reviewed in the study. The engineers recommended the fourth alternative based on the most long-term benefit to the city. Question was asked about choices and the decision the Metropolitan Council fit in acceptance of alternatives. The council was reminded that there may be opportunities to discuss additional work in different areas along the construction route such as storm drain improvements, street restoration and the like. Motion was made and carried with all ayes accepting the feasibility study and authorize the staff and consultants to negotiate the agreement with the city and the Metropolitan Council.

Alternate Urban Area Review

The council discussed the revised northwest and southwest Alternate Urban Area Reviews along with authorization for distribution to agencies. The council reviewed the responses pertaining to the revised mitigation plan. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting the resolution ordering the distribution of the revised Alternate Urban Area Review for the northwest and southwest Carver area.

Cathy's Tax Service

Cathy's Tax Tip

On August 31st, 2006 the IRS announced the standard amounts that most long distance customers can use to figure their telephone tax refund. TELEPHONE TAX REFUND? Believe it or not, the IRS is giving taxpayers that have paid long distance federal excise charges from February 28th, 2003 – July 31, 2006 a refundable credit, ranging from a standard amount of $30 - $60. The amount depends on the number of exemptions you claim on your 2006 personal tax return. You can also use the actual tax you paid calculated from your phone bills over the forty one (41) month period. Anyone that paid these excise taxes for a business is subject to different rules to calculate the amount of the credit.

This is a one time credit and is only available for the 2006 tax year and claimed on your 2006 tax return. If you aren't required to file a federal tax return but paid those excise taxes and would like to claim your refund, use form 1040 EZ-T. Remember that these excise taxes were also paid by most cell phone and VoIP (Voice over Internet Protocol) services. Take advantage of this credit!

Cathy Steigerwold

Sponsors

Carver Lions
We Serve

Replacement Windows Inc.
Maintenance Free Windows, Doors & Siding
Tom Gestach
Office (952) 448 4312
Mobile (612) 270-3264
Fax (952) 448-2874
Email www.tjreplacement@aol.com
16150 Dutch Road
Carver, MN 55315

My Bookkeeper, Inc.
Solutions for Small Businesses
Julie Peak
President
PO Box 625
Shakopee MN 55379
Phone 612.730.6030
Fax 952.361.9570
Email julie@mybookkeeperinc.com
website www.mybookkeeperinc.com

RCE ResCom Electric, Inc.
Commercial, Maintenance Services
Industrial, Residential
KERRY PETERSON
Office (952) 448-5923
Fax (952) 448-7296
640 County Road 40
P.O. Box 128
Carver, MN 55315

MUSTARD MOON
Open Just 3 Days Each Month!
2007 Dates
Jan 18, 19, 20
Feb 15, 16, 17
Mar 15, 16, 17
April 19, 20, 21
May 17, 18, 19
June 21, 22, 23
July 19, 20, 21
Aug 23, 24, 25
Sept 20, 21, 22
Oct 18, 19, 20
Nov 15, 16, 17
Dec 6, 7, 8
Thurs • Fri • Sat
10:00 ~ 5:00
300 Broadway, Carver
952.361.3282
• Pieces of the Past •
• Time Tarnished Wares •
• Home Comforts •

Olson Construction Co.
6970 INWOOD ROAD • COLOGNE, MN 55322
DOZERS, LOADERS, SCRAPERS, BACKHOES, BOBCATS & TRUCKING OF FILL, GRAVEL, ROCK ETC. ALL TYPES EXCAVATING RESIDENTIAL & SITE DEVELOPMENT, ROADS, BASEMENTS, SEWER & WATER, SEPTIC SYSTEMS
RON
(612) 448-5674
FAX (612) 448-5289
Emergency 426-1176
FREE ESTIMATES

Coupon
$15 off tax return preparation for new clients!
CATHY L. STEIGERWALD, E.A.

CATHY L. STEIGERWALD, E.A.
ENROLLED AGENT
(952) 240-5279
(952) 368-6050 FAX
carvertax@comcast.net
221 Broadway
P.O. Box 221
Carver, MN 55315

KleinBank
Patricia Kane
Personal Banker
p.kane@kleinet.com
304 North Broadway
P O. Box 38
Carver, MN 55315-0038
ph 952-361-5311
fax 952-361-5904
www.kleinet.com